CHAPTER

3

10 RULES TO TAKE CONTROL OF YOUR WEIGHT LOSS

An Easy-to-Follow Action Plan

In Chapter 2 you learned about insulin, and the complicated physiological processes it has on fat loss. Those details are important if you want to understand why my program works. Most readers will be more interested in what they need to do to successfully reduce their bodyfat loss, rather than why it works. Whether you understand the science or not, this chapter will give you a plan to put these physical principles into action.

Here I'll explain the 10 rules I want you to follow to put together your program. But I want to make this easy for you to implement. I don't want you to worry about constructing the nuts and bolts of this program yourself. In the chapters following this long one, I'm going to provide detailed guidance on what you need to do every day. I'll provide you with over 50 recipes in Chapters 8-10. They will help you adhere to the 10 rules I'm explaining in detail in this chapter. And I'll also provide a 30-day sample nutrition plan in Chapter 6.

You'll have all the tools you need to make this plan work for you.

So here are my 10 rules for fat loss:

RULE #1: Eat two or three meals per day (with no snacking)
RULE #2: Schedule your meals and your workouts ahead of time every day
RULE #3: Choose the right foods for fat loss
RULE #4: Follow the glycemic load principle
RULE #5: Get your portions right
RULE #6: Take BCAAs before and after your workouts
RULE #7: Drink the right fluids
RULE #8: Follow the rules, but allow yourself a cheat meal
RULE #9: Sleep long and deep
RULE #10: Keep track of your fat-loss results

RULE #1:
EAT TWO OR THREE MEALS PER DAY (WITH NO SNACKING)

This is the most crucial piece of information to understand how you successfully manage your bodyfat levels: **Our bodies can only burn stored fat when our insulin levels are low. Period, end of story.**

Virtually every food you consume encourages insulin release. So, if your goal is to reduce bodyfat, then you need to reduce insulin release. And the best way to do that is to only eat 2-3 times a day, preferably three. Here's what you need to do.

- Eliminate snacking between meals.
- Create longer windows between meals. I recommend spacing your breakfast and lunch apart by at least 5-6 hours. And then you should do the same between lunch and dinner.

This is the most efficient way to keep your insulin levels low for long periods, while also allowing you to take in an appropriate amount of food, nutrients and calories that support daily activity while shedding bodyfat. In addition, you won't go hungry on this plan.

ENTER THE "BURN ZONE"

Once your insulin levels have lowered, your body will be in a state I've dubbed the "Burn Zone." When you lengthen the time you're in a state where your body is not releasing insulin, your body will be encouraged to pull fat from storage to use as fuel for daily activity. If you eat every couple of hours, you'll constantly spike your insulin release. If you do that, you'll either never enter the Burn Zone, or you'll be there only for a short time.

Going for longer periods without consuming meals is more important than the foods you eat. No matter how clean your food choices, you'll have more difficulty burning bodyfat if you're constantly consuming foods or snacks, regardless of their quality. This is why planning the times for your meals is crucial to your success.

When you're in the Burn Zone, your body releases fat from storage, which you can then use to fuel workouts and daily activities. This activity further encourages additional release of stored fat, helping make your Burn Zone more efficient.

In addition to spacing your meals 5-6 hours apart, you should also make sure to consume the last meal before your workout at least 2-3 hours prior to exercise. That's because the additional calorie demands of exercise will further require the release of fat from storage.

When your body is burning fat for energy, you'll begin to see results much more quickly. The positive reinforcement will provide additional motivation to keep following my Superhero Nutrition program. After all, motivation in body transformation only occurs when you begin to see positive changes.

The key is to limit yourself to eating no more than three times a day with no snacking in between. Even healthy foods such as a handful of nuts will undermine the benefits you'll get from the Burn Zone.

KEEP YOUR BEVERAGES SUGAR-FREE

You can drink water, carbonated water (with no sodium or sugar), tea, and coffee between meals. But make sure you don't add anything to these drinks such as cream, sugar or sugar substitutes. Recent research indicates that even no-calorie sugar substitutes likely trigger insulin release. This is due to the fact that these chemicals mimic the activity of sugar in our bodies, which then releases insulin. And that's precisely what you're trying to avoid.

When you make this change, it will take a couple days to get used to it. For people like me who were eating 6-7 times a day, it will take somewhere between 3-7 days to get used to this new eating rhythm. You'll feel pretty hungry—and even sluggish—between meals, but then your body will adapt. Keep in mind that you're teaching your body to use fat, not sugar, to power you through your day.

As you get used to eating three times a day, you'll start having more energy. You'll start to experience greater focus with all of your daily tasks, including your workouts. My nutrition program will help you become a fat-burning, clear-thinking machine!

YOUR ACTION PLAN

- Eat only 2-3 meals a day
- Space each meal at least 5 hours after the previous
- Plan your workouts after you've gone at least 2 hours without eating

RULE #2:
SCHEDULE YOUR MEALS AND WORKOUTS AHEAD OF TIME EVERY DAY

It's important that you get your day started correctly from the get-go. That means you need to plan your first meal, and get up early enough that you can consume your other meals within a 5-6 hour window without waiting until late at night for your dinner (Unless you like to eat late at night, which still works, but that's up to you.)

After all, the first meal you eat sets up the timing of every other meal that follows. If you prefer to work out in the morning, then you need to eat your first meal **after** you exercise. Upon waking, your insulin levels are low, and your body is ready to burn fat. That's because you've gone about 12 hours since your dinner the night before. This guarantees a low level of insulin in a healthy person. Before or during your workout, you can drink black coffee, and you can even add up to a tablespoon of low-fat milk, but, again, don't add sugar or sugar substitutes.

You can add milk from any source (e.g., cow, almond, soy, etc.), so long as the amount you include does not exceed 10 calories. Read labels carefully to understand what you're adding to make certain you're not encouraging insulin release, which will prevent you from burning bodyfat.

Also, drink at least one eight-ounce glass of water before you start your workout to make sure you're properly hydrated before training. Then consume a total of two liters of water per day. This can vary from person to person, as some people are uncomfortable with water sloshing around in their gut while they train.

On the other hand, if you don't work out in the morning, then you should eat your first meal fairly shortly after waking. This will help you create those long windows between meals. At this point, you also need to figure out when you're going to have your lunch (at least 5 hours later), and when you're going to have your dinner (at least 5 hours after that). And then your workouts need to come at least 2 hours (if not 3) after one of these later meals. Plan accordingly.

THREE-MEAL-A-DAY SCHEDULES

Here are four examples of how to put your three-meal-a-day schedule together with a workout. Of course, you have a lot of flexibility with timing based on your personal needs, schedules and the time of day you prefer (or are able) to work out. Feel free to make adjustments to these examples based on your schedule.

Workout upon rising:

WORKOUT: 7 a.m.
BREAKFAST: 8:30 a.m.
LUNCH: 1:30 p.m.
DINNER: 7:30 P.M.

Workout after breakfast

BREAKFAST: 7 a.m.
WORKOUT: 10 a.m.
LUNCH: 1 p.m.
DINNER: 7 p.m.

Workout after lunch:

BREAKFAST: 7 a.m.
LUNCH: 1 p.m.
WORKOUT: 3:30 p.m.
DINNER: 7 p.m.

Workout after dinner:

BREAKFAST: 7 a.m.
LUNCH: 1 p.m.
DINNER: 6-7 p.m.
WORKOUT: 8-9 p.m.

TWO-MEAL-A-DAY SCHEDULES

If you prefer to skip breakfast or lunch, only taking in two meals a day, then here are three examples of how to put this schedule together. Of course, it's much easier to meet the timing criteria when you consume fewer meals in your daily schedule. I call the first time you eat "first meal," whether that's breakfast or lunch.

Workout upon rising:
WORKOUT: 7 a.m.
FIRST MEAL: 8 a.m.-12 p.m.
DINNER: 7 p.m.

Workout after first meal:
FIRST MEAL: 7 a.m.-12 p.m.
WORKOUT: 3-5 p.m.
DINNER: 6 p.m.

Workout after second meal:
FIRST MEAL: 7 a.m.-12 p.m.
DINNER: 5-7 p.m.
WORKOUT: 7-9 p.m.

Make sure you have a 2-3-hour break (preferably 3) from your last meal to the start of any workout program if you are trying to burn fat. Don't make yourself crazy if you only have a two-hour window from your last meal to the start of your workout session. The reason I prefer the three-hour window is because it guarantees that your release of insulin will be down, and you'll be in the Burn Zone.

And here's one more addition to the rules I lay out in this chapter: **Don't eat beef and carbs at the meal before your workouts.** The reason for this is that the insulin response to eating beef and carbs at the same time can last up to four hours because it digests slowly. While beef prevents you from entering the Burn Zone for several hours, that doesn't mean it's a bad food at other times of day. Later in this chapter, I'm going to address which foods you should consume and those you should avoid based on their glycemic impact.

SCHEDULE FOR NON-WORKOUT DAYS

The schedule on non-workout days is much simpler because you don't have to plan as much to create that 2-3 hour window before your workout where you don't consume a meal. Overall, my preference is that you eat three meals a day rather than two, but I understand that needs for fuel and lifestyle vary from one person to another.

When I eat beef, I like to make it my last meal of the day. By the morning I will start my day in the Burn Zone. You want to be in the Burn Zone for as much of your waking day as possible.

Remember, it's all about timing and what you actually eat is secondary. It's very important but still secondary.

YOUR ACTION PLAN

- Schedule your day ahead of time, whether you're training or not that day
- Follow my examples in setting up a 5-6 hour window between meals
- Create at least a 2-hour window between your last meal and your workout when your primary goal is burning fat
- Timing is even more important than food choices

RULE #3:
CHOOSE THE RIGHT FOODS FOR FAT LOSS

What and how much should you eat?

It should come as no shock that these are two different questions. And I'm going to answer them both in detail. First, I'll address food choices before I explain the portions that are right for you. Again, I'm going to make these easy for you. You aren't going to have to count calories or keep track of macronutrient grams so long as you follow my simple rules for food selection and portion control.

Knowing what you should consume on my plan is as much about realizing what you can take in as compared to what you shouldn't. Many foods will sabotage your fat-loss goals regardless of how many calories they contain.

So, here's what you need to know about food selection, which is broken down into macronutrient groups. Macronutrients consist of protein, fats, and carbohydrates.

PROTEIN SOURCES

My nutrition plan includes a list of optimal sources of protein. Some exceptional proteins, which I've included in the "primary proteins" list, are: whey, egg whites, fish, and chicken and turkey breast. These are low-fat, lean proteins that are absorbed most efficiently and used most effectively by your body to support muscle tissue. Some less exemplary proteins, or "secondary proteins," include: highly marbled cuts of beef, sausages, processed meats, cold cuts, duck, goose and lamb. Secondary proteins have higher fat contents, and are absorbed less readily, and I recommend you consume them sparingly.

PRIMARY PROTEIN SELECTION: Almost all lean meats work within the boundaries of my nutrition plan. The key is to avoid all processed meats, as well as meats that are extremely high in fat. When possible, choose grass-fed animal protein and opt for wild fish over farm-raised fish. Farm-raised fish are fed grains and that changes the nutrition value of the fish, reducing the amount of omega-3s and other healthy fats they contain.

PRIMARY PROTEINS

Poultry—skin off
Chicken thigh—skin off
Chicken leg—skin off
Chicken breast—skin off
Chicken wings—skin off
Turkey breast— skin off
Pork tenderloin
Pork chop
Lamb
Beef (lean)
Lean ground beef (85% fat or higher)
Buffalo
Duck
Fish (any)
Shellfish (any)
Eggs
Egg whites
Beef jerky
Milk low fat
Milk non-fat
Cottage cheese (low- or non-fat)
Cheese
Protein powder (whey, egg albumin)
Greek yogurt (plain)

SECONDARY PROTEINS

Highly marbled cuts of beef
Sausages
Any processed meats
Cold cuts (prepacked and processed)
Goose
Any form of fried protein

VEGAN/VEGETARIAN PROTEINS

Legumes

* Greens don't contain all the amino acids you need, but pairing them with beans and legumes can help make them complete with the nine essential amino acids.

Kale

Edamame

Collard greens

Quinoa

Spinach

Beans

Nuts

Soy

Tofu

Broccoli

Soy milk

Almond milk

Hemp (protein powder)

Tempeh

Nut butter (peanut, almond, cashew)

Pumpkin seeds

Seitan

CARBOHYDRATES AND CARB SUBSTITUTES

1) **ELIMINATE SUGAR** First and foremost, you need to cut refined sugar from your diet. Nothing encourages greater release of insulin or contributes to increased fat more than consuming refined sugar in any form.

CUT OUT: Desserts, sugary sodas and sweet breakfast muffins. **Sugar is illegal in my playbook.**

2) **ELIMINATE "STARCHY" CARBS.** Greatly reduce other forms of carbs, even some you have been led to believe are healthy. The primary objective of my plan is to help you reduce bodyfat and position you to build muscle. Foods that you've been told are healthy may spike insulin release, which works against your current goal. This even includes whole grains, which you should only consume in moderation.

CUT OUT: Bread, pasta, rice (both brown and white), potatoes (white). If this is too much to ask at the beginning, then just reduce the amount and frequency of these foods you consume.

3) ELIMINATE SUGAR SUBSTITUTES. Drastically reduce or eliminate sugar substitutes such as aspartame (Equal, NutraSweet), sucralose (Splenda), saccharin (Sweet'N Low, SugarTwin), neotame, and acesulfame potassium (Sunett, Sweet One). These sugar substitutes are included in diet sodas and many other foods. Interestingly, these no-calorie molecules mimic the activity of sugar. So, even though they contain no calories, they do encourage the release of insulin. They negatively impact your ability to lose bodyfat nearly as much as refined sugars do. The only difference is that they don't include calories, but that doesn't matter, because these chemicals are encouraging your body to release insulin and drive other calories to fat storage.
CUT OUT: Diet sodas, desserts with sugar substitutes, and even "healthy" products that use these dietary sweeteners that cause insulin release.

4) CHECK INGREDIENT LABELS. Don't be fooled by sugar alcohols (strange name because they actually do not contain any alcohol at all). Sugar alcohols are carbohydrates that naturally occur in certain fruits and vegetables, but they can also be manufactured. They are lower in calories than regular sugars.

Sugar alcohols are generally found in many processed foods. The general public does not use them when cooking at home. Many protein bars that are low in carbs use sugar alcohols to help make the bars edible. If you find yourself with an upset stomach or bloating after eating certain processed foods, check to see if the product contains sugar alcohols. Many people have a problem digesting them and spend years trying to figure out why their stomach bloats and never gets flat.
CUT OUT: Sugar alcohols, which include erythritol, isomalt, lactitol, maltitol, mannitol, sorbitol and xylitol. Once you cut out sugar alcohols for about a week you may seem (and feel) far less bloating. Check ingredient labels.

5) EMPHASIZE FOODS HIGH IN FIBER. Interestingly, fiber is a form of carbohydrates that is indigestible. But that doesn't mean fiber is bad. In fact fiber plays a crucial role in mitigating blood sugar and insulin release. Fiber does this by slowing absorption of other calories, causing less insulin release. And fiber also prevents some calories from entering your body, sweeping them through. This is a benefit because fiber makes you feel fuller while helping you consume fewer calories.

There are two types of fiber: soluble and insoluble. Soluble fiber dissolves in water, and it is known to help decrease blood cholesterol, slow digestion, and delay intestinal absorption of sugar and starch. As a result, soluble fiber helps keep insulin spikes lower.

Insoluble fiber is known for both regulating and speeding up digestion. Insoluble fiber also bulks up your stool, so if you are constipated this type of fiber is crucial. You can't have ripped abs if you're always constipated and bloated, so being regular is crucial to you achieving six-pack abs and reduced bodyfat. Consuming fiber is a good way to accomplish this.

ADD IN: Most high-fiber foods have both soluble and insoluble fiber, but some foods have more of one than the other. Oats, fresh fruit, and some vegetables are very high in soluble fiber. The average person should strive to consume between 20-35 g of fiber per day, combining both types of fiber.

FOOD HIGH IN SOLUBLE FIBER

Bran
Barley
Nuts
Seeds
Beans
Lentils
Peas
Avocado
Brussels sprouts
Broccoli
Asparagus
Apples
Pears
Oranges
Figs
Dates

FOODS HIGH IN INSOLUBLE FIBER

Wheat
Bran
Whole-grain foods
Most vegetables
Turnips
Okra
Green peas
Asparagus
Beets
Sweet potato
Broccoli
Brussels sprouts
Corn
Kale
Green beans
All berries
Apples
Apricots
Figs
Oranges
Pears
Plums

Net Carbs

Many people get confused when they see a label that says "net carbs," and a number associated with it. What that means is the total number of grams of carbs in a food minus the total amount of grams of fiber in that food. That's because fiber is not absorbed, so it contains no calories. Consuming fiber will never by itself raise your insulin levels or spike your blood sugar. The more fiber a food has, the lower on the glycemic load list it tends to be (I'll explain glycemic load later). Fiber has great health and fat-loss benefits.

DIETARY FAT SOURCES

I haven't discussed dietary fats, yet, but I'm going to say something that may surprise you: You shouldn't fear dietary fats when you're on a fat-loss program. In fact, you need to eat fats to lose fat. Why is that? Because dietary fats don't spike insulin levels nearly as much as carbs and protein. Yes, even protein encourages the release of insulin.

If you include three of the foods from any of the "healthy fat foods" list, then you'll be consuming the fats you need to provide the proper amount of calories with the satiety you need to reduce bodyfat. While you should emphasize healthy fats (especially omega-3s), you shouldn't fear saturated fats. These are the fats that naturally occur in meats and dairy products.

On the other hand, there is one source of fats you should avoid as much (or more) than sugar. These are trans fats. These are chemically altered fats that have been proved to cause myriad health problems. In fact, trans fats are the reason saturated fats got their bad rap in the first place. Virtually every diet and informed nutritionist excludes trans fats from their recommendations because of how harmful they are.

First, though, let's start with the healthy fats:

HEALTHY FAT FOODS

While many of these foods are high in protein, they should also be the foods you rely on to get many of your fats. Lean meats contain a proper amount of saturated fats that will help you succeed on your diets. Avocados, nuts and seeds contain healthy omega fats that support long-term health, satiety and weight loss when consumed in moderation.

Lean beef
Chicken
Turkey
Pork
Whole eggs
Avocado
Nuts
Flax seeds

HEALTHY OILS

These foods contain a much higher amount of fats by percentage—some oils are 100% dietary fats, constituted of varying ratios of saturated and unsaturated fats. The more saturated fats the oil contains, then generally the cloudier or more solid it becomes with refrigeration.

MCT oil
Olive
Macadamia
Canola
Peanut
Soybean
Sunflower
Safflower

HEALTHY FATTY FISH

Fish is both an excellent source of protein and dietary fats. While some types of fish are very lean, the following fish contain a high amount of healthy fats, which are otherwise consumed in too low of a quantity in most people's diets.

Salmon
Mackerel
Rainbow trout
Bluefin tuna
Yellowfin tuna
Arctic char
Albacore
Skipjack tuna
Black cod
Chilean sea bass
Sardines

HEALTHY FATS BUT NOT PREFERRED (EAT SPARINGLY)

These foods are higher in dietary fats than those you should consume on a fat-loss program. Still, you can include them infrequently and in small portions. Just make sure to follow the portion adjustments I recommend later in the book.

Fattier beef
Lamb
Duck
Coconut oil
Full-fat cheese
Butter
Ghee
Lard
Goose fat

TRANS FATS FOODS

Look for the ingredient "partially hydrogenated oil" on nutrition panels and avoid these foods, entirely.

Margarine
Doughnuts
Fried anything
Frozen pizza
Cream-filled candies
Frosting
Biscuits
Breakfast sandwiches
Microwave Popcorn (opt for ones with labels that read "trans-fat free")

YOUR ACTION PLAN

- Cut out all refined sugar (and sugar substitutes)
- Reduce other carbs sources (especially starchy sources)
- Emphasize quality "primary proteins"
- Don't fear dietary fat; include it in moderation so long as you avoid trans fats

RULE #4:
FOLLOW THE GLYCEMIC LOAD PRINCIPLE

Every food affects insulin response in a unique way. Many years ago, scientists tested most foods to determine their impact on insulin release, which led to the development of the glycemic index. The glycemic index rates foods from 0-100 on how much the food raises your blood sugar levels.

This seems perfectly in keeping with what I've been preaching so far, doesn't it? But it's wrong, and the answer is to look at glycemic load rather than the glycemic index. Let me guide you through both of these.

FLAWS IN THE GLYCEMIC INDEX

The glycemic index is based on how much each food encourages insulin release when you eat it alone and in large quantities. No one eats a meal that has only one food. It indicates how quickly a specific food is digested and released as glucose (sugar) into your blood stream.

Foods with a high glycemic index raise your blood sugar more than those with a low glycemic index rating. The way they tested this was by having subjects consume an amount of every food that contains 50 g of carbohydrates, and then they tested blood sugar levels. But they neglected to tell you that 50 g of carbs from different foods vary fairly significantly from the amount you'd normally consume.

For instance, if you're going to consume 50 g of carbs from watermelon, you're going to have to take in about 60 oz or five cups of this fruit! And watermelon scores a 72 on the glycemic index scale, an undesirable number. But the glycemic load for watermelon is 7.2, making it acceptable on my nutrition plan. Based on the glycemic index alone, you would never eat watermelon because you'd believe that it would spike insulin release and cause you to store these calories as fat. But you're not going to eat an entire watermelon—and nothing else—for your dinner. Are you?

The better way to view how foods impact insulin release is through their glycemic load, which takes into account how much of a food you consume in a typical serving, as well as how you should mix them together. That's why I base my food recommendations on glycemic load.

THE GLYCEMIC LOAD PRINCIPLE

The answer is to look at glycemic load, a scale developed by nutrition scientists at Harvard that takes your portions of each food into account, rather than the glycemic index, which compares unrealistic quantities of individual foods based on their carbohydrate content. The difference is crucial. In addition, you can further reduce insulin release by pairing foods together. I'm going to address that in more detail in Chapter 5, but it's an important point to mention now, before I go into it in more depth later.

SCORING FOODS ON THE GLYCEMIC LOAD PRINCIPLE

The glycemic load is a ranking system for carbohydrate foods, and the scale runs from 0-60. This measures the amount of carbohydrates and the impact of each food from one typical serving. Foods that are in the 0-10-range are considered low; those in the 11-20-range rank as moderate, and those above 20 are high and should be eaten sparingly. Here's how it works.

Take for example watermelon. Watermelon is very high on the glycemic index, rating a 72. But on the glycemic load scale it is quite low, coming in at 7.2 based on the fact that the typical serving is one cup (8 oz). This amount of watermelon doesn't have many carbohydrates. It's mostly water.

Carrots are another low glycemic-load food that scores high on the glycemic index (71), but low in its glycemic load score (6).

In my food plan, you'll emphasize foods with a low glycemic load. I'll get into this in more detail in Chapter 5 where I explain how to pair foods together, which will broaden your food choices. Then I'll provide you with recipes that take glycemic load and insulin release into account.

YOUR ACTION PLAN

- Take the glycemic load of foods into account
- Know that the glycemic index is flawed based on unfair quantity comparisons
- Read Chapter 5 to better understand how to construct your diet based on the much more accurate glycemic load

RULE #5:
GET YOUR PORTIONS RIGHT

In terms of portion control, this is literally in your hands. Your hand will become your calorie monitor without you ever having to count a calorie. For any given meal, you must first decide which source of protein you'll be eating. Then you'll determine your carbohydrate source per meal.

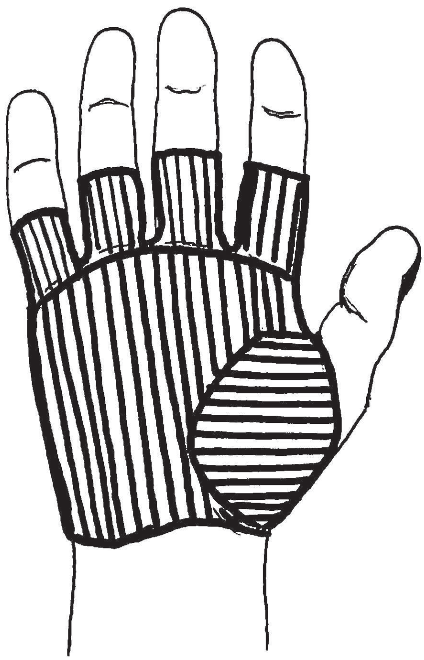
If your goal is to reduce bodyfat and weight, then you should limit your protein portion to approximately the size of your palm, which includes the heel of your hand and first row of knuckles (length and thickness). If you want to maintain your current weight and just drop fat, limit your protein portion to the size of your entire hand. If you would like to gain a lot of muscle and increase total bodyweight, then your protein portion should be the size of your entire hand plus a half of your other hand.

A meal of salmon sashimi and edamame is my favorite lunch. I often eat it 2-3 times a week. You can vary your foods as much as you want. The size of the protein here is palm and first row of knuckles.

On the other hand, if you only eat two meals a day, then your protein can start as your entire hand instead of your first row of knuckles. If you want to maintain your current weight, your protein can be the size of your whole hand plus a half, and if you want to gain large amounts of muscle then go with then two full hands for each meal.

HAND-SIZE PORTIONS

These three diagrams provide examples of how you should measure your protein serving for each meal. For more diagrams and insight on using hand portions, go to **atighteru.com**.



Reduce both bodyfat and weight

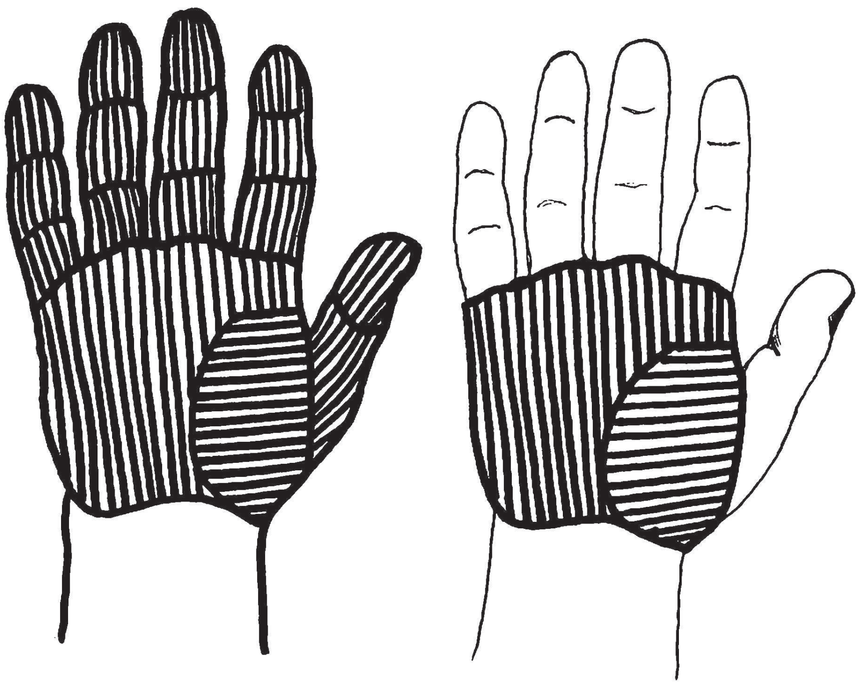
When this is your goal, limit your protein for each meal to a portion size equal to your palm plus the heel of your hand and first row of knuckles.

Carb Portions

Based on your choice of protein, you will determine which carbohydrates you should appropriately pair with that protein and the quantity of each. I'll give you more details about this in Chapter 5, where I provide you with the scores for carbohydrates on the glycemic load scale.

Maintain your weight and lose bodyfat

When this is your goal, consume a piece of primary protein that's equal to the size of your full hand.



Gain muscle and lose bodyfat

When this is your goal, you should consume a protein serving that's equal to the size of your full hand plus half of your other hand.

Suffice it to say for now that if you choose a carb food that is low on the glycemic load scale, then you can eat about double the amount as compared to what you're consuming for protein, but if you choose a carb with higher glycemic load, then you should eat about an equal volume of carbs as compared to your protein portion.

I call this the 1:2 or the 1:1.5 or 1:1 ratio. Here's how it works;

If you choose a good protein =1, then:
You choose a low GL carb = 2 (double size of carbs to protein, and you can have more than one type of these carbs)
You choose a medium GL carb = 1.5 (1.5 size carb as protein)
You choose a GL high carb = 1 (same size carb serving as protein)
Here are quick examples of each of these carb options after you choose a quality protein source. You can also see photos demonstrating this concept on page 88-91.

EXAMPLE: 1:2 RATIO

PROTEIN	LOW CARB	LOW CARB
Chicken breast	Broccoli (same size as protein)	Cauliflower (same size as protein)

EXAMPLE 1:1.5

PROTEIN	MEDIUM CARB	MEDIUM CARB
Chicken breast	Lentils (3/4 size of the protein)	Sweet potato (3/4 size of the protein)

EXAMPLE 1:1

PROTEIN	HIGH CARB
Chicken breast	Risotto (same size as the protein)

YOUR ACTION PLAN

- Choose your protein portion based on your physique goal
- Select a carb source that balances your protein portion and allows for satiety
- Read Chapter 5 to better understand how to pair foods together

RULE #6:
TAKE BCAAS BEFORE AND AFTER YOUR WORKOUTS

I believe that you should get most of your nutrients from food. One exception is branched-chain amino acids (BCAAs). BCAAs are a group of three essential amino acids: leucine, isoleucine and valine. They're the basics of protein molecules, which means they are a macronutrient. Yet BCAAs are unique and should be supplemented because we don't get in enough from our food supply.

BCAAs are essential amino acids. The term "essential" means something different here than it typically does. In the context of amino acids, the "essential" ones are those that your body cannot make from other amino acids, making it necessary to get them through your food or supplements. Essential amino acids often provide specific advantages, but they are not typically as necessary for survival or crucial physiological functions. Our bodies have become expert chemists when it comes to making non-essential amino acids. These are the ones we need most for health and survival. Yeah, I know, the names feel a little off, but these are the scientific terms for them.

BCAAs are very crucial "essential amino acids," providing unique advantages. In particular, BCAAs promote muscle protein synthesis and, therefore, muscle growth. Research also suggests that BCAAs provide additional muscular energy during workouts, allowing you to perform more reps in a set.

WHY BCAAS WORK

BCAAs are a crucial part of my program. They not only promote muscle growth, but they also encourage your body to burn fat. The more muscle a person has, the more calories they burn daily to sustain the muscle they have.

The key is to get your body to preferentially burn fat. Remember that one of the biggest reasons diets fail is that people lose muscle mass, which makes it more challenging to burn bodyfat. Supplementing BCAAs when you're on a fat-loss program will help you maintain muscle mass while improving your body's ability to burn stored fat.

BCAAs encourage your body to release insulin to achieve their advantages. This may sound like something you don't want (unless you read my chapter on insulin very carefully). But you actually want your body to release insulin immediately after your workouts. And, depending on your goal and workout, it may be desirable to release insulin before you train.

HOW BCAAS WORK

BCAAs are not synthesized in your liver (where amino acids are converted to carbs), so they are transported throughout your body as amino acids. Insulin transports BCAAs directly to working muscle tissue to help repair the damage your workouts cause. This encourages muscle growth and faster recovery, providing you with more energy the next time you workout. This won't make you bulkier, because more muscle fibers fit into a small space.

Muscle fibers are lined with insulin receptors, like a dock for a boat. Once the insulin docks, it tells the muscle cell to allow glucose and amino acids to enter the muscle. This docking increases protein synthesis, which is fundamental for building muscle and speeding recovery.

Once your body uses the glucose in the muscles and liver to fuel the workout—which won't last all that long—it then calls on the stored energy in your fat cells to continue to power your workout. Now you're cutting directly into your stored fat to fuel your training! That is the key part to the benefits of my workouts and my program.

HOW TO TAKE BCAAS

Many people recommend that you take BCAAs with other supplements and ingredients, such as protein shakes that are high in sugar or sugar substitutes. But these other calories often end up preventing fat from being released to fuel your workouts or getting stored in fat cells. So, you should take BCAAs with water or other low- or no-calorie beverages, such as black coffee or tea.

My program is based on timing. It is essential you take your BCAAs within five minutes of starting your weightlifting and right after you finish. If you are doing your cardio right after, take your BCAAs when you finish your cardio.

On days when you split your cardio and weights, take the BCAAs before and after your workouts. Do the same thing on days when you just do cardio. BCAAs are still beneficial for supporting recovery from cardio because that type of training also breaks down muscle tissue.

BCAAs will slightly spike your insulin levels for a very short period and drive the amino acids straight into your muscles.

People might say, "Wait a minute. If you're spiking your insulin won't this shut off your fat burning? Shouldn't I take BCAAs only after (but not before) my weight-training workouts?"

Pure BCAAs stimulate a quick insulin response after taking them. Since there are no carbohydrates in your system at this time (if you're following my program), then your insulin spike will be very short. The amino acids are delivered right into the muscle to keep them from breaking down and fuel immediate exercise. The short interruption in fat burning is well worth it because instead of losing muscle, you're setting up your body to build muscle and lose more bodyfat over time.

Immediately after your weightlifting session take your second dose of BCAAs and eat a meal if the timing is right. A great time for a meal is directly after a weight-lifting session, but this is a challenge unless you're training 4-5 hours after your previous meal. If your schedule doesn't allow for a meal right after your workout, then at least take your BCAAs. That will start your muscle recovery and building process, which will boost your metabolism for more effective fat burning.

MORE MUSCLE, BETTER METABOLISM

While some people like to take in some form of artificial metabolism booster, all you're really getting is caffeine or some other form of natural speed. The problem with these products is they only last for a short time. The best way to up your metabolism to boost fat loss is to add lean muscle. And muscle mass is the best and cheapest fat-burner out there. Building muscle is the name of the game when it comes to upping your metabolism, and with the right supplementation at the right time you can build it easily.

I train models, actors/actresses, professional and Olympic athletes, and bodybuilders. The one thing they all have in common besides having me as their trainer is that I have all of them taking BCAAs. My preference is BCAAs from Hollywood Supps.

YOUR ACTION PLAN

- BCAAs boost metabolism, build muscle and help reduce stored fat
- Take at least 3 g of BCAAs five minutes before your weight-training workouts
- Take at least 3 g of BCAAs immediately after your full workout

RULE #7:
DRINK THE RIGHT FLUIDS

One of the primary rules of every fat-loss program is that you need to watch the beverages you consume. That's true on mine as well. Beverages full of calories provide very little satiety, and they often cause a spike in insulin. This won't surprise you: You'll be cutting out beverages that spike insulin.

But you should also up your fluid-intake game when you're on a fat-loss program. Remember I said earlier that one of the problems with most diets is that you lose water weight, but you don't lose fat? Well, you don't want to lose water weight. That means you need to stay well hydrated.

Here are my rules-within-a-rule:

1) Avoid fruit juices.

You may have been told a glass of orange juice in the morning is one of the healthiest things you can consume. No piece of nutritional advice could be more wrong. Fruit juice is one of the worst things you can take in when you're trying to reduce bodyfat. Pure fruit juice contains nothing but carbohydrates (sugar) with virtually zero fiber. Drinking it drives insulin release through the roof! One glass of orange juice contains the fruit from multiple oranges (between 5-7), but without the beneficial fiber that whole oranges contain. In addition, fruit juice is very high in fructose, a type of sugar you particularly want to avoid.

On the other hand, it's perfectly fine to consume whole fruits that are high in fiber such as oranges, papayas, pineapples or grapefruits. That's because the fiber in these fruits reduces the release of insulin, making them acceptable food choices on my fat-loss program. In addition, these foods have a low glycemic load due to their low amount of calories per serving.

2) Avoid other sugary and sugar-substitute beverages.

You already know that sugar causes an unwanted release of insulin. Sugary sodas (and other beverages) often contain high-fructose corn syrup, or other ridiculously unhealthy versions. This type of sugar is even more damaging to your health and fat-loss program than table sugar (sucrose). Even companies such as Coke and Pepsi have started marketing new versions of their sugary beverages, touting that they contain sucrose, which is less harmful than high-fructose corn syrup.

And, as I explained earlier, even diet sweeteners trigger the release of insulin.

Again, that's because these chemicals mimic the structure of "real" sugars, and your body responds in kind, releasing insulin, which you don't want most times of day.

3) Avoid "healthy" caloric beverages.

Even vegetable beverages are suspect. Once again, these remove the fiber in favor of "nutrients." But these nutrients take a backseat to the damage that vegetable juice causes due its sugar content and subsequent insulin release. Keep in mind that even protein shakes cause an insulin release. You can take these in after workouts to provide amino acids, but these products cause your body to release insulin, which spikes appetite. And that's not what you're seeking on a fat-loss program. Sure, protein shakes can be beneficial if you're trying to add muscle mass and bodyweight, but be careful about how you consume them when you're trying to shed bodyfat.

You should avoid "healthy" sports beverages. You've seen commercials that show athletes downing them during a game to give themselves an extra boost. One look at the labels and you can see that they're full of sugar, and they're going to spike insulin release. These products will support activity, but they do so in addition to causing insulin release, which you need to avoid in order to lose fat.

4) Consume at least two liters of water a day.

Many times we feel hungry when we're actually thirsty. Most people do not drink enough water, and they find themselves eating food instead of just downing a glass of water, which is what their body is actually seeking. While food contains water, it's a huge waste of calories to consume food when your body is thirsting for water. In general, if you're having a craving, I recommend that you consume a glass of water before you give in to any temptation.

Water provides many other health benefits, as well. It flushes out your kidneys and digestive system, hydrating your body and brain, allowing your metabolism to function more effectively. You also look healthier when you're well hydrated.

5) Drink water, tea, and coffee.

Coffee and tea are both loaded with antioxidants, and they're mostly water. In addition they are virtually calorie free. You can drink these beverages hot or cold, but don't add sugars or sugar substitutes, or consume diet drinks, which cause unwanted insulin spikes.

While you should consume two liters of water a day on its own, you can also think of your coffee and tea drinks contributing to your water consumption. Many people argue that coffee and tea are "dehydrating," but that's ultimately not true. If you ate tea leaves or coffee beans, perhaps you'd be less hydrated, but consuming these beverages with water makes this a nonsensical point. Still, strive to get in two liters of water, however much coffee or tea you drink. The fluid in coffee and tea are a bonus.

6) Drink raw, unfiltered apple cider vinegar diluted in water before every meal. Recent studies suggest that drinking two tablespoons of raw, unfiltered apple cider vinegar diluted in 12 oz of water may have significant health benefits. It lowers blood pressure and acid reflux, and it supports weight loss and the health of diabetics. You can probably guess the reason for the latter: it reduces insulin spikes.

A study performed at Arizona State University concluded that drinking apple cider vinegar before meals and at bedtime reduced post-meal and fasting glucose levels by up to 40%. By drinking this mixture right before you start to eat, not 20 minutes before but right before, you return to the Burn Zone much more quickly.

People who regularly consume this apple cider vinegar beverage have reported feeling more full between meals, although that has not been scientifically proved. But this makes sense to me—reducing insulin release helps decrease appetite. This can put you in the Burn Zone for about 1.5 more hours per day, because it reduces insulin release by about 30%.

I've stressed the importance of keeping insulin levels low with the shortest spikes possible. Including watered-down, raw, unfiltered apple cider vinegar is an essential component of my fat-loss program. *Do not* drink it straight because it can lead to an upset stomach and irritate your throat; always dilute it with water. By drinking it unfiltered, you can add up to 1.5 hours of the Burn Zone to your day. I even add a little lemon or lime to reduce the taste of vinegar. Lately, I've been adding sparkling water with no calories or diet sweeteners, also a good option.

YOUR ACTION PLAN

- Drink at least 2 liters of water every day
- Avoid fruit juices and other sugary beverages, including sodas and sports drinks
- Consume raw apple cider vinegar diluted with water before every meal
- Drink coffee and tea without added calories as you want

RULE #8:
FOLLOW THE RULES, BUT ALLOW YOURSELF A CHEAT MEAL

By now you should know that you can't have a rule without an exception and so here is mine: Once a week you should consume a cheat meal, consuming whatever you want.

It's important that you still follow all of the other rules at every other meal throughout the week, but a cheat meal provides benefits. In fact, you're not—exactly—cheating; rather, you're supporting your fat-loss program.

When you're on a disciplined program, your body accommodates to the amount of calories you consume, regardless of how much you're controlling insulin release. I mentioned earlier that taking in food causes your body to rev up its fat burning. Of course it doesn't do that to the extent that it burns all of the calories you're consuming. But digestion does burn calories. Taking in a cheat meal once a week encourages your body to rev up metabolism to digest this unexpected intake of food. But when you do this frequently (especially every day), your body gets used to this huge influx of calories, and it just expects them and stores them as bodyfat.

Cheating once a week also sends your body the signal that it's not in starvation mode, and it doesn't need to hoard bodyfat.

Here are my guidelines for cheat meals:

Plan your cheat meal in advance. Make this meal as important as every other meal. You can eat whatever you want in this meal, but it's good to include protein, fats, and fiber. You can also add some refined sugar. This once-a-week insulin spike will not ruin your diet; in fact, it may better support it.

Keep calorie intake moderately high: It's a cheat meal—you can go a little nuts. You can take in 1,000-1,500 calories during this meal, depending on your bodyweight and muscle content. For example, one slice of cheese pizza has about 285 calories. The more muscle you have, the more calories you can consume during the meal. Just don't turn it into a full-out gorge fest.

Contain your cheat window. One of the best ways to prevent yourself from "over cheating" is to keep your "cheat meal" window to about two hours. Don't cheat before, and don't cheat afterwards. It's not a free-for-all.

YOUR ACTION PLAN

- Cheat only for one meal once a week
- Plan your cheat meal and eat whatever foods you want
- Keep quantities to no more than "moderately large"
- Contain your cheat window to 2 hours

RULE #9: SLEEP LONG AND DEEP

According to the Center for Disease Control and Prevention, more than 35% of Americans are sleep deprived. What's intriguing is that the statistics for obesity are nearly identical. I'm not suggesting that every person who doesn't get enough sleep is obese, but I am suggesting there's likely a link between the two.

Getting in less than seven hours of sleep per night, especially over extended periods, has many deleterious effects. It's no shock that lack of sleep undoes or diminishes your weight-loss goals. Who wants to train when they're tired? You may not want to go to bed, but you'll be more likely to go home and sit on the couch for an extra hour rather than head to the gym if you're under-rested.

Research also suggests that getting too little sleep negatively impacts the effects of insulin. Studies show that four consecutive nights of poor sleep reduces a person's insulin sensitivity by up to 30%. That means that your body will need to release more insulin even though you're not consuming excess calories, and those calories will more likely be driven to fat storage.

When you sleep long and deep, your body also releases several important hormones, including growth factors such as IGF-I, which support muscle-building, recovery from training, and ultimately fat-loss. This alone could explain why under-sleeping fights against your fat-loss goals.

In addition, lack of sleep also stimulates appetite even though you're not burning that many more calories by being awake.

Some good news about my plan, and how it supports sleep: Because you'll be eating no more than three meals per day, you'll be unlikely to be digesting food into the night, which also disrupts sleep.

Here are my eight tips on how to get a better night's sleep.

GET YOUR ZZZS

1) Take melatonin.

Melatonin is a hormone found in the human body. Melatonin helps regulate the sleep and waking cycle, and it helps balance your hormones. In addition, the human body releases growth hormone and reduces cortisol secretion during sleep. The deeper and longer you sleep the better your body will work the next day.

Ingesting supplemental melatonin may help you sleep better, lose body-fat, gain muscle mass and function more effectively. I use Hollywood Supps Melatonin to provide an extra boost of this critical hormone. The best time to take it is just as you're getting into bed. This version of melatonin is delivered as a gummy, which is better than a pill or liquid because the gummy acts as a transport system, delivering the melatonin more efficiently. Since the total calorie count of each dose is under 10, the gummy will not spike your insulin levels.

Keep in mind that as a person ages, the natural level of melatonin production decreases. That makes melatonin supplementation more important as you get older to support better health.

2) Drink plenty of water throughout the day.

Dehydration causes your heart rate to increase even during sleep. Going to bed hydrated helps you sleep longer, better and deeper. Consider drinking water if you awake during the night unless you know that will further disrupt sleep due to a need to use the bathroom.

3) Go to bed at the same time every night.

And get up at the same time every morning to create a natural sleep rhythm. The more regular your sleep patterns, the better advantages you'll gain from sleep, and from my program in general, as it will help you better plan your full 24-hour cycle with meals and workouts.

4) Avoid alcohol.

Alcohol is not only unhealthy, but it disrupts your sleep patterns. While many people use alcohol to help them get to sleep, it often disrupts sleep later in the cycle (or prevents you from getting into deeper more restful stages of sleep). When good sleep and fat loss are your goals, avoid alcohol.

5) Hide your clock

Set your alarm, but don't watch the clock when you wake up in the middle of the night. It's easy enough to do — set your clock within reach, but turn the face so that you can't see it when you're lying down.

6) Wear socks to bed.

A Swiss study published in *Nature* observed warm hands and feet are the fastest way to fall asleep. https://www.nature.com/articles/43366

7) Perform self-acupressure.

Between your eyebrows and above your nose is a pressure point. Apply gentle pressure for 1 minute. Breathe in and out slowly as you do this to help slow your heart rate and relax yourself.

8) Shut off the TV and put on classical music.

It will either lull you to sleep or bore you to the point where sleep will be the best escape. Keep the volume low, and set a timer to turn it off, if possible.

YOUR ACTION PLAN

- Sleep is an important part of good health
- It's also crucial for supporting fat loss
- Follow the tips in this section for better sleep

RULE #10:
KEEP TRACK OF YOUR FAT-LOSS RESULTS

Those before-and-after photos exist for a reason: They're extremely effective at marketing any fat-loss or muscle-building nutrition or training program. That's a bit psychological, a way to entice you to buy into a certain program, and spend money on everything they're selling.

But that's not the only reason for those shots: They're also hyper-motivating for those on the program. You get frequent feedback, and you're able to see your improvements in a variety of ways. While many of these "quick-fix" programs are bogus, they rely on actual motivators. My program delivers long-term fat-loss, and I want you to use these metrics to keep track of your progress over the long haul.

I strongly suggest you keep track of your changes from the start of your program through the finish line. These aren't marketing and hype when they're *your* results. They're real. And they're really motivating.

That's the topic of the next chapter.


PRESS
0
10
20
30
40
131
133
134
138
139
140